

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Using Software Maintenance and Technical Support to the Fullest



Learning Outcome:

Understand information about people's backgrounds in spoken or written documents.

Participate in the improvement of IT contracts, establishing technical clauses that respond to the needs of the negotiating agents, based on current laws on contracting.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think software maintenance and technical support are important when acquiring licensed software? Why? Why not?
- How long do you think this service should last? Why?

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about the concepts of maintenance and support in a software license agreement.
- I can talk about exclusions and qualification for software maintenance and technical support.
- I can discuss considerations in regards to the duration of service for software maintenance and technical support.





Let's Explore!

A trainer is instructing his trainees on software maintenance and technical support.



Instructions: Read the text below.

Trainer: As you know, software license agreements come with offerings of important services to guarantee the correct use and performance of the licensed software. These are typically known as "Software maintenance" and "Technical support". Can anyone tell me what the differences between these two are?

Trainee: Well, software maintenance is usually about software patches and fixes, and software updates. Sometimes, these can mean major upgrades or newer versions of the licensed software. Technical support, on the other hand, refers to remote technical advice for the correct use of the software and assistance to solve related problems. A helpdesk service, known as "first level support", might be included in the technical support, or by not including helpdesk assistance, some companies offer second level support, which might be limited to the customer's internal helpdesk personnel.

Trainer: Good, but let me add that limited remedies might be offered if the software vendor fails to provide the promised level of service. What about exclusions and qualifications?

Trainee: By establishing these, the software vendor's obligations are limited. For example, this support may be limited to current versions of the software or difficulties caused by the use of software in breach of the software license agreement might be excluded. Problems that may be replicated by the software vendor in the software vendor's technical support environment might also be limited.

Trainer: Great answer! Finally, do you have anything to say about the duration of the service?

Trainee: According to the customer's preference, software maintenance and technical support might be optional. However, this kind of service is usually limited by the vendor and by doing this, problems may appear for the customers if they want to use the licensed software for a lengthy period of time.

**Let's Practice!**

Software maintenance and technical support, any difference?

Instructions: Read the question. Select all the correct answers.

1. What are software maintenance and technical support about?
 - a. Software maintenance is usually about software updates, patches and fixes. It may be included in the licensed software.
 - b. Technical support refers to remote technical advice for the correct purchase of the software and assistance to solve related problems that might be included in the licensed software.
 - c. "First level support" might be included in the technical support.
 - d. Software maintenance and technical support refer to the same process of fixing computers and other technological devices.
 - e. Technical support refers to remote technical advice for the correct use of the software and assistance to solve related problems that might be included in the licensed software.

**Let's Practice!**

What about the exclusions and qualification for software maintenance and technical support?

Instructions: Read the conversation. Circle the correct word to complete the sentence

Trainer: Good, but let me add that limited remedies (might be offer / might be offered / may be offer) if the software vendor fails to provide the promised level of service. What about exclusions and qualifications?

Trainee: By establishing these, the software vendor's obligations are limited. For example, this support (may be limited / might be limit / may be limit) to current versions of the software, or difficulties caused by the use of software in breach of the software license agreement (may be excluding / may be exclude/ might be excluded). Problems that (may be replicated / might be replicate / may be replicate) by the software vendor in the software vendor's technical support environment (may also be limit / might be also limit / might also be limited).



Extension Activity

Differences between software maintenance and technical support

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look for information about software maintenance and technical support.
- Describe their differences and main characteristics.
- Write a comparison chart to differentiate those two concepts, qualities and considerations in regards to their duration.
- Share the chart with your classmates.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

- | | | |
|---|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. I look for information about software maintenance and technical support. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 2. I describe their differences and features. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 3. I write a comparison chart. | ☐ | ☐ |
| 4. I share the comparison chart with my classmates. | ☐ | ☐ |



Target Words

- **remote technical advice** (noun): remote assistance provided by companies to technology users.
e.g. Technical support, on the other hand, refers to remote technical advice for the correct use of the software and assistance to solve related problems.
- **software patch** (noun): record of changes made to a set of resources.
e.g. Well, software maintenance usually is about software patches and fixes, and software updates.
- **upgrade** (noun): a software that enables enhancements over the earlier version of another software or program.
e.g. Sometimes, these can mean major upgrades or newer versions of the licensed software.
- **exclusion** (noun): specific condition or circumstance included in a contract as not covered.
e.g. What about exclusions and qualifications?
- **helpdesk service** (noun): a resource created to provide the customer with information and support regarding the proper use of a service or product.
e.g. A helpdesk service, known as "first level support", might be included in the technical support.
- **qualification** (noun): part of a contract that contains reservations and restrictions.
e.g. What about exclusions and qualifications?



Learning Points

The Passive of Modal Verbs: May and Might

We use the **passive voice** when we want to give importance to the object of a sentence or when the subject is not important or unknown.

We use the **passive form** of the modal verbs **may** and **might** to talk about situations that are likely to happen and whose doer is not important. However, there is a subtle difference between the two of them. We use **may** to express that something is possible but **might** to suggest a lower possibility.

Object	may/might	be	main verb (past participle) or complement
<i>The acquisition of this software</i>	<i>might</i>	<i>be</i>	<i>optional.</i>

Examples

- *A helpdesk service, known as "first level support", might be included in the technical support, or by not including helpdesk assistance, some companies offer second level support, which might be limited to the customer's internal helpdesk personnel.*
- *Good, but let me add that limited remedies might be offered if the software vendor fails to provide the promised level of service.*
- *For example, this support may be limited to current versions of the software, or difficulties caused by use of software in breach of the software license agreement might be excluded.*

Verb + Ing After Prepositions, Position of Not

If we want to use a **verb after a preposition**, it always has to go in its -ING (gerund) form.

Prepositions are usually followed by **noun- phrases**. If we want to include a verb (as the subject of the sentence) it must be in the **gerund form**. An infinitive (to-) can never be placed there.

If you are going to use the negative form, you just have to put the particle **not** before the gerund.

For example:

*By **not guaranteeing** helpdesk assistance, companies may offer different types of supports.*

Examples

By establishing these, the software vendor's obligations are limited.

By not including helpdesk assistance, some companies offer second level support, which might be limited to the customer's internal helpdesk personnel.

However, this kind of service is usually limited by the vendor and by doing this, problems may appear for the customer if they want to use the licensed software for a lengthy period of time.